

BBC 6 Minute English Listening Practice

Building a Better World with Wood

Name: _____

Class: _____

Score: _____ / 16

NO MORE THAN THREE WORDS - A change in building materials

No.	Sentence
1	Earlier British buildings commonly used _____; modern builders have largely turned to manufactured materials.
2	In wooden schools, children show greater _____, alongside other physical and emotional benefits.
3	Rooms made of wood or other natural materials, or with a view of nature, are linked to better patient _____.
4	Wood captures _____, which helps in the fight against climate change.
5	The architect names bamboo, _____ and flax as growable materials considered for construction.
6	The architect's examples range from tall buildings to _____ and schools.
7	Layers of pine are laid _____ and then glued together.
8	Tests indicate that the resulting plywood has strength _____ that of steel.

11 **How has the choice of building materials in Britain changed over time?**

- A Wood became common only after concrete and steel were introduced.
- B Brick was traditionally dominant, but timber is now replacing it.
- C Timber was widely used before manufactured materials took over much of its role.
- D Natural materials remained dominant despite the arrival of concrete and steel.

12 **What broader conclusion does the architect's school example support?**

- A The materials in a learning space may affect children's wellbeing and learning.
- B The view from a classroom is the main influence on children's heart rates.
- C The effects depend mainly on how old the school buildings are.
- D The physical benefits in wooden schools are stronger than the learning benefits.

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

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- 13 **Why are some governments interested in replacing concrete and steel with wood-based materials?**
- A The raw materials needed for concrete and steel are becoming scarce.
 - B Finished concrete buildings need more maintenance than wooden ones.
 - C Concrete and steel create a less comfortable indoor environment.
 - D Making concrete and steel has a high carbon burden.
- 14 **What makes bamboo, hemp and flax relevant to the architect's proposal?**
- A They have already replaced steel in several types of building.
 - B They are materials that can be grown and considered for construction.
 - C They are processed in exactly the same way as layers of pine.
 - D They are useful mainly for making rope and strong cloth.
- 15 **What does the architect's list of skyscrapers, housing and schools illustrate?**
- A Wood is most suitable for buildings where children spend time.
 - B Tall buildings are easier to make from wood than homes are.
 - C Careful use of wood could suit several different kinds of building.
 - D Growable materials have already replaced steel in these buildings.
- 16 **Which condition does the architect place on the wider use of growable materials?**
- A Builders should combine them with steel in tall structures.
 - B Governments should secure their supply before changing designs.
 - C Designers should restrict them to buildings made mainly of wood.
 - D The materials need to be used with careful judgement.
- 17 **What is the point of comparing plywood with steel?**
- A The comparison challenges the idea that wood-based construction must lack strength.
 - B The comparison shows that plywood has a similar weight to steel.
 - C The comparison suggests wooden buildings need fewer safety checks.
 - D The comparison shows pine performs better than other kinds of wood.
- 18 **What do the buildings in Norway and Milwaukee demonstrate?**
- A Plywood is becoming the preferred material for the world's tallest towers.
 - B Wood-based material has already been used in substantial tall buildings.
 - C Both cities have adopted the same design for their wooden towers.
 - D The two buildings were designed to compare plywood across climates.